Tump Farm Water Project

Visitor Q&A draft. Prepared 16 August 2026.

> This is a simple explanation of the project: using spring water carefully, while helping the land hold more winter rain so water reaches streams and rivers more slowly through the year.

Questions Visitors Might Ask

What is going on here?

Peace Water's aim is to use water here to help people and places elsewhere. The spring gives a steady supply of water that has travelled underground and been filtered slowly through soil and rock.

At the same time, this is not just about taking water. The project is also about helping the land hold more rain. Tree planting and better soil cover can slow raindrops, open soil channels, reduce muddy runoff, and help more water soak into the ground.

Will the trees help the spring?

Possibly, but not directly or quickly. Hydrology, the movement of water above and below ground, is complex. Different waters move at very different speeds.

Spring water has probably spent years or decades underground, slowly moving through leaky rock before it appears here. Shallow groundwater moving through soil may take weeks or months to reach a stream or river. Surface runoff can arrive in hours or minutes, carrying mud, causing damage, adding to floods, and sometimes putting lives at risk.

The trees may not feed this exact spring. Their job is broader: slow the fast water, reduce damaging runoff, and help more rain join the slower, safer water cycle.

So why work on the land as well?

Any water taken from the spring is water that does not continue straight on to the River Usk at that moment. The project should therefore aim to give something back: helping the farm hold more rainfall, reduce fast runoff, and support steadier water movement through the land.

Doesn’t all the water end up in the river anyway?

Mostly, yes. The important question is timing.

If rain rushes off compacted ground in winter, it can add to high flows and flooding when the river already has plenty of water. If more rain soaks into soil and moves slowly underground, it can support streams, springs and the river later, when dry weather matters more.

Why do steadier water levels matter?

Wildlife is better supported by steadier conditions than by sharp swings between winter floods and summer lows. Slowing runoff can also reduce erosion, keep more soil on the land, improve water quality, and reduce flood risk downstream.

Why trees first?

Trees are low-tech, low-impact and useful in many ways at once. Leaves slow raindrops. Roots open soil channels. Tree belts can give shelter, habitat, shade, carbon storage and better soil structure, while also helping water soak in rather than racing away.

Mechanical earthworks can be useful in some places, but on heavy or compacted ground they may seal up, need maintenance, or create new risks. Trees are a safer first conversation.

What are we trying to measure?

The first aim is not to prove a perfect number. It is to build confidence step by step: measure the spring flow, observe wet and dry weather, test how fast water soaks into different soils, and record where runoff concentrates after rain.

What would success look like?

Success would mean a small, respectful spring use alongside visible land improvements: more water soaking in, less muddy runoff, healthier soils, more trees, better habitat, and a project that visitors and young people can understand by walking the land.